



Special edition Leica M-P

Leica has launched a limited edition camera that costs \$15,000 and comes with pimple-out rubber grips. <http://dgit.in/LeicaCamr>



FB Messenger's less data

Facebook Messenger Beta users on Android can enable 'Data Saving' mode to cap data consumption. <http://dgit.in/FBMsngDS>

Bazaar

Google Pixel XL

What Google thinks

The Nexus is no more, and Pixel is truly what Google wants Android to be. It's got its own launcher, a bunch of goodies that are exclusive to the Pixel line, and even an Assistant that wants to change how you use your smartphone.

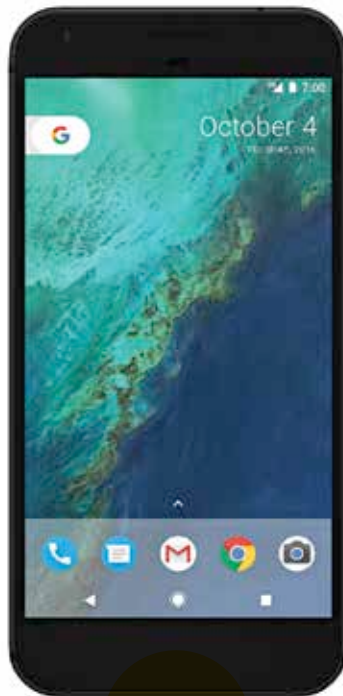
The Pixel XL costs as much as an iPhone, but it doesn't bring the same premium feel with it. Google's take is utilitarian, the Pixel is a functional smartphone that represents the best of Android today. Its metallic back feels nice, but the glass part of the back is baffling. It impedes the seamlessness of design, making the Pixel feel rather like a budget device, than something expensive and premium. This is not a phone to show off.

It runs on a Snapdragon 821, which Qualcomm says is 10% more powerful than the 820. There's a certain fluidity about using the Pixel that we haven't seen on most Android phones. On regular tasks, like social networking, mail, IMs and more, the phone feels incredibly fluid and fast.

The Pixel does stutter, but it's better than a Galaxy S7 Edge or HTC 10. Google has worked hard to reduce things like touch latency, the Pixel launcher is evidently more than just an appearance overhaul. The background enhancements make the Pixel XL feel so smooth.

However, the Pixel XL does tend to heat up easily. We got it up to 47 degrees on stress tests, which isn't a very good sign. On gaming, the phone tends to reach the 40 degree mark in about 20 minutes. This of course results in processor throttling, which brings down the speed.

The Pixel XL doesn't lag when you say "Ok Google" to turn on the Google Assistant. Neither does it do so if you long press the home button to bring up the Assistant. The Assistant is basically an evolved version of Google Now. It is more conversational and can remember context. In fact, it even knows what's on your screen.



Price
₹67,000

The best aspect of the Pixel XL is its camera. The 12.3MP sensor has the same 1.55 micron Pixel size as the Nexus 6P, and both phase detect and laser auto-focus. Images from the Pixel XL are largely accurate in terms of colours, although the white balance was off in some low light shots. Images can sometimes be cooler than usual, but nothing that can't be fixed.

However, we aren't quite convinced with Google's claim that this is the best camera ever on smartphones. The Pixel XL doesn't really surpass the iPhone 7 Plus in overall image quality. The iPhone produces better colours at times, and its dual-camera setup makes it better

at creating bokeh. That said, the Pixel XL still has one of the best smartphone cameras today.

We were slightly disappointed with the Pixel XL's battery life. The phone has a QHD display, which does take a toll on it, based on your usage. While the display itself is great, the combination of that, and the high-end performance, gives the Pixel just about a work day's worth of battery life. This is pretty much the industry standard today, but we expected a bit more.

The Pixel has a gorgeous display, though. It achieves a maximum brightness of 805 Lux, brighter than the iPhone 7 Plus, OnePlus 3 and others. The contrast and colour balance are also very well done. The panel is slightly warm, like most AMOLEDs, but just enough to like it without complaining. The touch performance is also great and the display feels really premium.

The Google Pixel XL is a great smartphone, and a great first attempt by Google. However, it's not the phone that'll dethrone the iPhone. For now, the Pixel XL poses a real challenge to phones like the Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge and any other Android flagship, but the 67k price tag means there's a lot more work to be done.

Prasid Banerjee



Features	66
Performance.....	84
Design & Usability.....	93
Value	50

Specifications

Display: 5.5 inch QHD;
SoC: 2.15 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 821; **RAM:** 4GB; **Storage:** 32/128 GB;
OS: Android 7.0 Nougat;
Camera: 12.3 MP rear, 8MP front; **Battery:** 3450 mAh

Contact

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